



Tandy Corporation

News Release

For Release: August 27, 1992
Contact: Tony Magoulas
817/878-4852

TC-93-007A

TANDY CORPORATION ANNOUNCES NEW DIGITAL INFORMATION FORMAT Video Information System Products to Use New Interactive Multimedia Technology

FORT WORTH, Texas -- Tandy Corporation today announced development of a digital information delivery system which will launch a new generation of information products for the home.

"This new format enables us to create a unique product class that will provide a window to the world of digital information for the mass consumer," said John V. Roach, chairman and chief executive officer of Tandy Corporation.

"Our purpose was to develop a technology that could be integrated into a new generation of products tailored to the learning, information and family entertainment needs of the 1990's home," he said. "Products utilizing this innovative technology will allow interaction with the pictures, voice, music and animation contained in exciting applications that offer the home user a new and compelling experience. The essential point is that we have created a delivery system that will make a *VIS* product a fun, informative learning experience that the whole family can enjoy anytime they wish."

According to Roach, Tandy set out in 1989 to bring the latest advances in interactive multimedia technology to a low cost home information product aimed at the mass consumer marketplace.

To identify compatible products using the new technology, Tandy has created a format name and distinctive logo -- Video Information System (*VIS*)™.

-- more --

Tandy Introduces New Digital Information Format

Page two

The basic *VIS* product will typically be used in the living room or family room. It is intended to fit comfortably in an entertainment center or as a set-top TV device. Its primary function initially, will be as a *VIS* title player -- that is, a *VIS* disc is dropped in and it "plays" the title. As *VIS* products evolve, it is expected that other methods of delivering digital information to the home will be used by the *VIS* player to provide unique applications for the home consumer.

Licensed *VIS* hardware products will carry the distinctive *VIS* logo making it simple for consumers to identify products, titles and accessories compatible with their *VIS* system.

Compton's Multimedia Encyclopedia™, the world's first illustrated, animated and sound-enhanced encyclopedia, will be included with all *VIS* products. The specially designed *VIS* version contains the entire text of the 26-volume Compton's Multimedia Encyclopedia and the complete Webster's Intermediate Dictionary featuring thousands of colorful illustrations, exciting animated sequences and interesting speech and sound -- all on a single *VIS* disc.

Nearly 50 software and content publishing companies are already committed to delivering over 100 *VIS* titles. *VIS* software titles will range in price from \$29.95 to \$79.95. The software will be primarily distributed by software products distributors or through direct purchase by retailers.

"*VIS* was created with a sensitivity to the family's desire to improve their children's educational performance and literacy skills," said Roach. To bolster *VIS* as a learning tool, the 1992 titles list contains 26 children's reading development and classic literature titles and 16 other learning titles.

-- more --

Tandy Introduces New Digital Information Format
Page three

Beginning this fall, *VIS* products will be sold by consumer electronics retailers and department stores nationwide, including Tandy's own Radio Shack® stores under the Memorex® label.

VIS products will also be sold by Zenith Electronics Corporation under the Zenith brand to other consumer electronics outlets across the nation including Tandy Name Brand Retail Group McDuff Electronics® stores, VideoConcepts® and The Incredible Universe®.

Tandy will manufacture the *VIS* product in its Advanced Technology manufacturing facility in Fort Worth, Texas.

VIS products are expected to be available in stores before Christmas.

###

Video Information System and *VIS* are trademarks of Tandy Corporation.
Compton's Multimedia Encyclopedia is a trademark of the Compton's Learning Co., a Division of Encyclopaedia Britannica.
Radio Shack, McDuff Electronics and VideoConcepts are registered service marks used by Tandy Corporation.
Memorex is a registered trademark used by Tandy Corporation.
The Incredible Universe is a service mark of Tandy Corporation.
MS-DOS is a registered trademark and Windows is a trademark of Microsoft Corporation.
The absence of a ® or a ™ in connection with the mark identifying products of other vendors does not indicate the absence of registration of those marks.